

ATi Express unstoppable

ATi's new graphics card, the R420 will have a completely different architecture from the R3XX series. The R420 is being developed under the project name Loki. ATi is looking at releasing it late November 2003, and making it publicly available from early 2004. The card features support for both, Pixel Shader 3.0 and Vertex Shader 3.0. It is speculated that the card will sport GDDR2 mem-



ory and a clock speed of 500 MHz.

It will be fabricated on a 130nm process. The company recently said that its next-generation VPU would have more than 200 million transistors.

R420 will have native support for PCI Express (formerly known as 3GIO). The PCI Express will be the interface for both, video cards, and other add-on cards, thus replacing the AGP/PCI combination. The support for PCI Express will be available from mid-2004. Till then, ATi plans to use the AGP-PCI Express bridge to make the card work with the existing AGP 8X interface.

May the best game win

Every year, Electronic Entertainment Expo, (E3), the platform for bold new ideas or great sequels of the gaming world.

One of the most anticipated games exhibited this year was *Half Life 2*, the sequel to the popular best-selling game. *Half Life 2* has been in development for the past 5 years, and grabbed four major

awards at E3, this year.

Halo 2, the sequel to the Xbox hit, bagged the Best Console Game award. *Halo 2* is well under development, and is looking to be as good, if not better than the original game.

E3 also saw massively multiplayer online role playing games (MMORPG) making a wide emergence like never before. *City Of Heroes* was an

ambitious project, that took the honours for the Best Online Multiplayer Game. The game will be made such that you will stand apart from other characters by way of unique costume combinations. The game will feature nemesis similar to the super villains seen in major comics. The developers, Cryptic Studios, have not set a release date for the game.

redalert

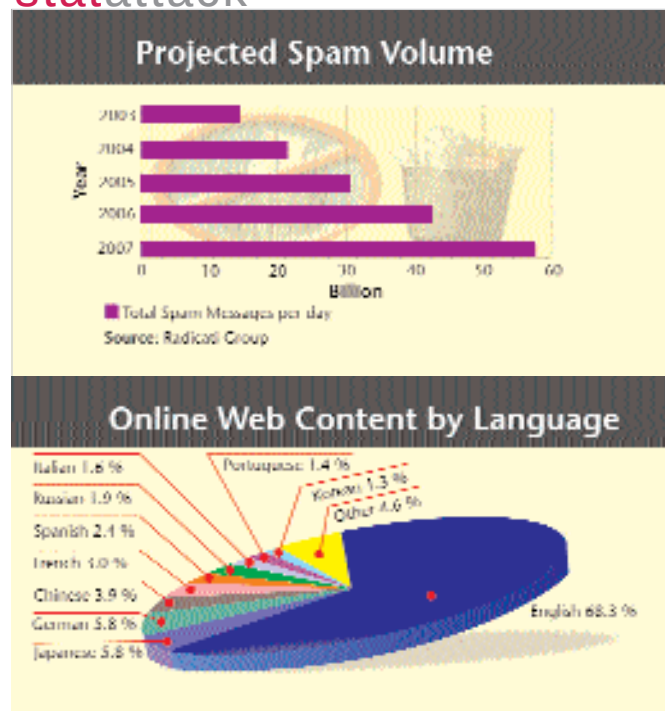
Bugbear

BugBear.B spreads through e-mail and shared network drives, and e-mails itself to addresses found on the local system. It gathers e-mail addresses from files that contain contact information—from both the To and From fields.

The virus also carries an attachment, with a double file extension, <file>.html.exe.

Upon execution, the worm creates two .DAT files into the Windows folder with different file names, and then copies these files into the Windows Startup folder. It also contains a keylogger that is copied into the Windows system folder as a DLL file. A backdoor component is also executed, that listens on the TCP Port 1080 for instructions. Visit <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/FxBgbear.exe> for a removal.

statattack



INFOGRAPHICS: Sachin Dalvi

The PSX is coming

Sony has announced an Upgrade to the popular PlayStation 2 gaming console making it more than a gaming device. The new PlayStation, dubbed PSX, will have a DVD writer, a TV tuner, a 120 GB hard drive and the ability to download movies and music. It also offers a USB 2.0 port, support for a memory stick and is equipped with an Ethernet adapter. The optical drive will have a slot-loading interface, and the processor will be the same as that of the PS2. The company claims that this is not PlayStation 3, but an entertainment box that is a crossover between game machines and consumer electronics devices.

Fortnight F

JS/Fortnight.c@M spreads by inserting HTML code into messages sent through Microsoft Outlook Express. It creates a new HTML file, and sets it as Outlook Express's default signature file. It exploits a flaw in Internet Explorer in order to propagate itself.

When the message is accessed, a remote site is contacted. The site contains encoded JavaScript, which loads an applet that carries the exploit. The virus makes several changes to IE's settings, designed to take you to the virus author's Web site. You can download a patch at <http://www.microsoft.com/technet/security/bulletin/ms00-075.asp>.

■ Microsoft takes over the Romanian firm, GeCAD Software, makers of anti-virus technologies for Linux and Novell